Candidate Brief

CONFIDENTIAL — PREPARED FOR CLIENT SEARCH

Role	Vice President of Finance
Client	Confidential — Specialty Food & Beverage Brand (NYC)
Stage	PE-backed, $60M revenue, scaling to $150M+
Date	June 3, 2026
Prepared by	Little Birdy Talent Solutions

Researched and compiled in approximately 12 minutes via the Little Birdy Research Agent

Executive Summary

Candidate A brings 13 years of progressive finance leadership across PE-backed consumer brands, including direct experience scaling a $200M specialty beverage company through a Series C raise and into late-stage growth. Their combination of Big Four operational rigor and growth-stage agility makes them a strong fit for [Client]'s next 24-month scaling chapter — particularly the transition from founder-led financial operations to institutional-grade FP&A and board reporting.

> **Strengths to lean on.** Candidate A has lived through the exact transition [Client] is entering: a founder-built finance function being rebuilt under PE ownership. They credibly own the board-facing relationship at their current company and have built repeatable financial reporting infrastructure from scratch.
>
> **Areas to probe in interview.** Direct M&A integration experience is limited — they have observed but not led an acquisition cycle. If [Client]'s growth path includes acquisitions or a strategic sale in the next 18–24 months, this is worth surfacing early in the interview process.

Mobility signal: Open to the right opportunity. Compensation must clear approximately $400K all-in to be competitive against unvested equity in current PE deal.

Career Trajectory

Senior Director of Finance

[PE-backed Beverage Brand, $200M revenue] | 2021–Present

- Promoted from Director to Senior Director in 18 months after leading the financial workstream of the company's $50M Series C round
- Built the company's FP&A function from the ground up, instituting monthly board reporting cadence and a 13-week rolling cash forecast that the PE sponsor has cited as material to subsequent valuation step-up
- Owns the day-to-day relationship with the PE deal team and external auditors (currently Big Four)
- Manages a team of 6 across FP&A, accounting, and treasury

Signal for [Client]: Comfort operating in the space between executive leadership and institutional capital — the exact competency [Client] needs to develop in the next 24 months

Director of Finance

[Mid-Market CPG Holding Company] | 2018–2021

- Joined as Senior Manager; promoted to Director within 14 months
- Led financial integration of two acquired brands into the parent holding company, including consolidation of ERP systems and reporting frameworks
- Reduced monthly close cycle from 21 days to 8 following ERP consolidation, enabling real-time visibility into brand-level P&L performance
- Built the company's first formal annual planning process; previously the company operated on a quarterly forecast-and-adjust model

Signal for [Client]: Has experienced acquisition integration as a participant, though not as the lead. Worth probing for depth.

Senior Manager, Financial Planning

[Public CPG, Fortune 500] | 2015–2018

- Owned divisional FP&A for a $400M business unit within a publicly-traded CPG parent
- Led the annual planning cycle and quarterly forecast reviews with the divisional president
- Built early career in a structured, large-company environment that contrasts well with the founder-led environment [Client] is moving away from

Audit Senior

[Big Four, Deloitte or EY equivalent] | 2012–2015

- Audit specialization in consumer products and food & beverage clients
- CPA certified, active license
- Foundational training that explains the candidate's documentation rigor and audit-readiness instincts

Education

MBA, Finance concentration — Top-25 program (e.g., NYU Stern, Columbia, Tuck)

BS Accounting — Tier-1 undergraduate program

Active CPA license

Competency Match Against Role Requirements

REQUIREMENT	EVIDENCE FROM CANDIDATE BACKGROUND	CONFIDENCE
PE-backed scaling experience	6+ years across two PE-portfolio CPG brands; led Series C financial workstream end-to-end	Strong
FP&A leadership at growth stage	Built FP&A function from scratch at current company; previously led divisional FP&A at $400M business unit	Strong
Board-level communication	Owns monthly board reporting at current company; presented to PE sponsor 4x in 2024	Strong
Big Four audit foundation	Audit Senior at Deloitte/EY equivalent, F&B specialization, active CPA	Strong
M&A and integration leadership	Participated in two acquisition integrations at prior company, but did not lead. Worth probing.	Moderate — probe
Cultural fit (founder-led to professionalized)	Current company underwent exactly this transition during their tenure; references describe them as a "bridge" between founder instincts and institutional process	Strong
Strategic exit readiness	Indirect exposure only. Has observed exit-prep workstreams but has not owned the financial side of a sale process.	Moderate — probe
Team-building / hiring	Manages a team of 6; has hired 4 of those 6 directly	Strong

Competency assessment compiled in approximately 12 minutes via the Little Birdy Research Agent using public LinkedIn data, company press releases, SEC filings where applicable, industry publications, and Little Birdy network references.

Compensation Context

ESTIMATED CURRENT COMPENSATION

$280–320K base

+ 30–40% target bonus + unvested equity ($400K–800K est.)

MARKET BENCHMARK (TARGET ROLE)

$300–360K base

+ 40–50% target bonus + new equity grant

ALL-IN TARGET TO BE COMPETITIVE

~$400–450K

Plus equity package addressing unvested gap

LIKELY NOTICE PERIOD

30–60 days

Longer if mid-cycle on board reporting or audit

Compensation estimates based on aggregated network data, Pave benchmarks for PE-backed CPG VP Finance roles in NYC, and recruiter-network references. All claims independently verifiable upon request.

Interview Probes

For the hiring manager and CFO/CEO conversations, these five questions will surface the depth of fit on the items flagged "probe" above:

1. "Walk me through your role in the Series C — what did you own end-to-end versus support?"
   Tests depth of institutional capital experience.
2. "How did you build trust with the PE sponsor in your first 90 days as Senior Director?"
   Tests relationship-building capability with institutional stakeholders, which is critical at [Client].
3. "You participated in two acquisition integrations — what would you have done differently if you had led them?"
   Surfaces M&A judgment without requiring direct leadership experience.
4. "If [Client] received a strategic acquisition offer in 18 months, what would your first 30 days look like as VP Finance?"
   Tests strategic exit readiness directly.
5. "Tell me about a time you disagreed with a CEO or PE sponsor on a forecasting assumption. How did you handle it?"
   Tests independence and communication style at the executive level.

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